

## SOC Investigation Templates

Evidence register, query journal and incident-report forms

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**Classification:** Student Training Material

Authorised synthetic training use only.

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Source: templates/evidence-log-template.md

# NeoLabs SOC Evidence Log Template

Record evidence used in an authorised investigation. This template is for training and case discipline; it does not replace organisational forensic procedures or legal chain-of-custody requirements.

## Case information

| Field                | Entry                |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| Case / assignment ID |                      |
| Analyst              |                      |
| Assigned pod         |                      |
| Investigation start  | YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC |
| Report path / link   |                      |

## Evidence register

| Evidence ID | Date/<br>time<br>collected<br>(UTC) | Event<br>time<br>range | Source<br>system | Evidence<br>type                                                                        | Collection<br>method /<br>query | Original<br>location | File or<br>record<br>hash,<br>when<br>applicable | Handling /<br>redaction<br>note | Releva |
|-------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------|
| EV-001      |                                     |                        |                  | Alert / raw<br>event /<br>export /<br>screenshot /<br>config /<br>owner<br>confirmation |                                 |                      |                                                  |                                 |        |

## Evidence-quality checks

For each important item, consider:

- Was the source operating during the event period?
- Is the timestamp event time, ingest time or alert time?

- Is the time zone known?
- Could the record be duplicated, delayed or truncated?
- Did a decoder or parser alter the displayed fields?
- Is the value source-generated, user-controlled or enrichment data?
- Is the evidence complete enough for the conclusion?
- Was sensitive data redacted without removing necessary meaning?

## Evidence statements

Use one statement per important claim.

**EV-\_\_**

**Observed fact:**

**Source and time:**

**What this evidence supports:**

**What this evidence does not prove:**

**Quality or visibility limitation:**

**Related evidence:**

## Transfer or review record

| Date/time UTC | Evidence ID(s) | From | To / reviewer | Purpose | Method | Confirmation |
|---------------|----------------|------|---------------|---------|--------|--------------|
|---------------|----------------|------|---------------|---------|--------|--------------|

## Final checks

- [ ] Every report fact points to an evidence ID or clearly identified source.
- [ ] No credential, private key or enrolment token is included.
- [ ] Personal or cross-pod information is removed or escalated rather than published.
- [ ] Screenshots show the required context and do not replace available raw records.
- [ ] UTC conversions are documented.
- [ ] Negative findings include the source, query and time range.

Source: templates/query-journal-template.md

# NeoLabs SOC Query Journal Template

Record searches as they are performed so another analyst can reproduce the investigation. Replace secrets and private endpoints with approved references; never paste enrolment tokens or private keys.

## Case information

| Field                | Entry |
|----------------------|-------|
| Case / assignment ID |       |
| Analyst              |       |
| Assigned pod         |       |
| Investigation date   |       |
| Primary alert        |       |

## Query register

| Query ID | Time run (UTC) | Platform / source                     | Exact query or filter | Event-time range | Result count | Important result or negative finding | Evidence IDs | Next pivot |
|----------|----------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------|--------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|------------|
| Q-001    |                | Wazuh /<br>OpenSearch /<br>local tool |                       |                  |              |                                      |              |            |

## Detailed query record

Q-\_\_

**Question being tested:**

**Data source and index/view:**

**Exact query/filter/command:**

**Time field used:** Event time / ingest time / other

**Time range:**

**Fields displayed or exported:**

**Result summary:**

**Relevant evidence IDs:**

**Limitations:**

**Decision / next query:**

## Query-quality checks

- ☐ The query uses the intended field rather than only free-text search.
- ☐ Exact and analysed fields are distinguished where applicable.
- ☐ The event-time field and time zone are recorded.
- ☐ A zero-result search was checked against source health and retention.
- ☐ Filters inherited from a dashboard or saved view are recorded.
- ☐ Wildcards and broad searches are narrowed before drawing conclusions.
- ☐ Commands were run only against synthetic data or explicitly authorised systems.
- ☐ Output containing sensitive values was redacted before submission.

## Investigation summary

**Most useful query:**

**Most important negative finding:**

**Visibility gap discovered:**

**Queries recommended for higher-tier review:**

Source: templates/incident-report-template.md

# NeoLabs SOC Incident Report Template

Use for authorised VCC exercises and approved synthetic investigations. Replace instructional text before submission. Do not include credentials, private keys, enrolment tokens or unredacted personal information.

## 1. Report control

| Field                | Entry                                                      |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Report title         |                                                            |
| Case / assignment ID |                                                            |
| Analyst name         |                                                            |
| Track and cohort     | SOC Level 1 /                                              |
| Assigned pod         |                                                            |
| Report version       | 1.0                                                        |
| Prepared at          | YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC                                       |
| Reviewer             |                                                            |
| Classification       | Training use / confidential programme material as directed |

## 2. Executive summary

Write 3–6 sentences for a reader who may not know Wazuh or the scenario. State:

- what triggered the investigation;
- the affected account, service or asset;
- the most important confirmed facts;
- the current classification and confidence;
- the recommended next action.

Do not include unsupported claims or long raw-log extracts.

### 3. Alert and detection information

| Field                         | Entry                     |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Alert name                    |                           |
| Alert / rule ID               |                           |
| Detection source              |                           |
| Alert creation time           |                           |
| Earliest confirmed event time |                           |
| Tool-assigned severity        |                           |
| Analyst-assigned priority     |                           |
| Relevant ATT&CK behaviour     | Optional; explain mapping |

### 4. Scope

#### Affected identities

| Identity | Type | Role / context | Confirmed or suspected impact |
|----------|------|----------------|-------------------------------|
|----------|------|----------------|-------------------------------|

#### Affected assets and services

| Asset / service | Identifier | Criticality / role | Evidence of impact |
|-----------------|------------|--------------------|--------------------|
|-----------------|------------|--------------------|--------------------|

#### Network, file and cloud indicators

| Indicator | Type | Source | Relevance and limitation |
|-----------|------|--------|--------------------------|
|-----------|------|--------|--------------------------|

### 5. Observed facts

List facts directly supported by evidence. Number each fact so it can be referenced later.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.



## 6. Timeline

Use UTC unless the assignment specifies otherwise. Separate event time from ingest or alert time when relevant.

| UTC time | Source | Entity | Observed activity | Evidence reference | Confidence |
|----------|--------|--------|-------------------|--------------------|------------|
|----------|--------|--------|-------------------|--------------------|------------|

## 7. Evidence reviewed

| Evidence ID | Source | Collection / query method | Time range | Integrity or quality note | Location / reference |
|-------------|--------|---------------------------|------------|---------------------------|----------------------|
|-------------|--------|---------------------------|------------|---------------------------|----------------------|

EV-001

Use the separate evidence log for detailed records.

## 8. Queries performed

| Query ID | Data source | Query / filter | Time range | Result summary | Next pivot |
|----------|-------------|----------------|------------|----------------|------------|
|----------|-------------|----------------|------------|----------------|------------|

Q-001

Use the query journal when more detail is required.

## 9. Analysis

### Interpretation

Explain what the combined facts suggest. Connect evidence through identity, time, process, network, session, request, file or resource pivots.

### Alternative explanations considered

| Alternative | Evidence supporting it | Evidence against it | Status |
|-------------|------------------------|---------------------|--------|
|-------------|------------------------|---------------------|--------|

Open / unlikely / ruled out

### Visibility gaps and limitations

State missing data, parser failures, disconnected sources, clock issues, retention gaps or permissions that limit the conclusion.

## 10. Classification and confidence

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                           |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Classification         | False positive / benign positive / suspicious / confirmed incident / insufficient evidence / data-quality issue |
| Confidence             | Low / medium / high                                                                                             |
| Confidence reasoning   |                                                                                                                 |
| Potential severity     | Informational / low / medium / high / critical, according to assignment definitions                             |
| Business or lab impact |                                                                                                                 |

## 11. Actions and recommendations

### Actions already taken

Record only authorised actions actually performed.

- 1.
- 2.

### Recommended next actions

| Priority | Recommendation | Owner / escalation target | Reason | Deadline |
|----------|----------------|---------------------------|--------|----------|
|----------|----------------|---------------------------|--------|----------|

Do not claim that a recommendation has been implemented unless evidence confirms it.

## 12. Escalation decision

| Field                                  | Entry    |
|----------------------------------------|----------|
| Escalated?                             | Yes / no |
| Escalated to                           |          |
| Time                                   |          |
| Reason                                 |          |
| Information supplied                   |          |
| Questions requiring higher-tier review |          |

## 13. Lessons and detection improvements

- Which field or source was most valuable?
- Which evidence was missing?
- Did the detection title and severity accurately describe the activity?
- What safe tuning, logging or playbook improvement is recommended?
- What should the analyst do differently next time?

## 14. References and attachments

List approved screenshots, exports, evidence IDs, task instructions and public references. Use repository-relative paths where possible. Redact sensitive values.

## 15. Reviewer notes

| Reviewer          | Date | Decision | Required corrections |
|-------------------|------|----------|----------------------|
| Approved / revise |      |          |                      |